

Website Report

Week 2: Foundational Web Development & Brand Introduction

Objective

To establish the foundational architecture of the Erasmus Brew website using raw HTML5, prior to implementing a Content Management System. This phase focused on structuring content and introducing the core brand identity.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- Document Structure: I've built the initial framework using standard HTML5 boilerplate (`<!DOCTYPE html>`, `<html>`, `<head>`, `<body>`) to ensure modern browser compatibility.
- Semantic Tagging: Implemented standard HTML tags to establish a clear content hierarchy. Utilized `<h1>` tags for primary page titles and section headers to improve readability and basic SEO structure.
- Media Integration: Embedded external image assets (`<img>`) to begin defining the visual aesthetic of a "cozy, modern cafe."
- Content Organization: Structured the cafe's initial offerings using unordered lists (`<ul>` and `<li>`) and separated distinct thematic sections using horizontal rules (`<hr>`).
- Footer Definition: Implemented the `<Footer>` tag to anchor the page with vital local business information, specifically the physical location (Washingtonova 67).

Brand Messaging Developed

During this week, the core conceptual copy for Erasmus Brew was finalized and published to the site. The brand was officially positioned as a welcoming, student-focused environment designed for productivity, relaxation, and connection.

Week 3: Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) & Brand Aesthetics

Objective

To transition the site from a raw HTML document to a visually engaging, responsive webpage by implementing external CSS. This week focused on applying the Erasmus Brew brand colors, ensuring mobile accessibility, and refining the user interface.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **CSS Integration & Architecture:** I successfully linked an external stylesheet (style.css) to the HTML document to separate structure from presentation. I established a clean CSS architecture starting with global variables.
- **CSS Custom Properties (Variables):** I defined global custom properties (:root) for the brand's core color palette, specifically setting --primary-color to Coffee Brown and --bg-color to a Cream Background. This ensures design consistency and allows for highly efficient global updates in the future.
- **Mobile-First Responsiveness:** I implemented fluid images (width: 100%) so the hero image scales automatically to fit any screen size. Furthermore, I ensured all interactive list items met mobile accessibility standards by setting a minimum touch-target height (min-height: 44px).
- **Layout & Centering:** I utilized Flexbox on the body element to control the flow of the page. To improve readability on desktop displays, I applied a max-width constraint of 600px with auto-margins, elegantly centering the content container.
- **Advanced UI Styling (Pseudo-elements):** I removed the default browser list bullets and utilized CSS ::before pseudo-elements. This allowed me to programmatically inject custom Unicode emojis (☕, 🍰, 🍷) directly into the DOM for each specific menu item, elevating the cafe aesthetic without adding unnecessary HTML markup.
- **Footer Component Design:** I transformed the basic footer into a distinct visual component. I applied a matching beige background, a solid brand-color border, and sharp corners (border-radius: 0) to anchor the bottom of the page professionally.

Week 4: Content Management System (CMS) Migration & Sandbox Deployment

Objective

To migrate the static HTML/CSS prototype into a dynamic, scalable environment. This week involved establishing a live development sandbox, installing WordPress, and initiating the digital transformation of Erasmus Brew.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **Environment Provisioning (Pantheon):** I configured a live WebOps sandbox environment using Pantheon. This provided an isolated, secure workspace to develop and test the site before public launch.
- **WordPress Core Installation:** I successfully deployed WordPress as the core CMS framework, laying the foundation for advanced plugin integration and dynamic content management.
- **Domain Configuration:** I established the primary development URL (<https://dev-erasmusbrew.pantheonsite.io/>) to facilitate testing and share progress milestones.
- **Initial Content Mapping:** Began the process of transitioning the foundational brand messaging and layout concepts from the local HTML prototype to the live WordPress infrastructure.

Week 5: Web Analytics & Conversion Tracking

Objective

To implement robust web analytics and establish foundational conversion tracking to monitor user engagement and business KPIs.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **Analytics Infrastructure (GTM):** I integrated Google Tag Manager as the central tag management system (Container ID: GTM-5BCWSRC3) to streamline the deployment of tracking scripts without modifying core site code.
- **Traffic Monitoring (GA4):** I deployed Google Analytics 4 via GTM (Measurement ID: G-CYJS0JKM0X) to capture comprehensive user behavior data, traffic sources, and session metrics.
- **Conversion Event Tracking:** I configured custom event tracking to measure high-value user actions. Specifically, I established a trigger to fire a 'generate_lead' event whenever a user navigates to the digital menu (URL containing /menu). This allows the tracking of intent and the measurement of the conversion rate of visitors expressing interest in the cafe's offerings.

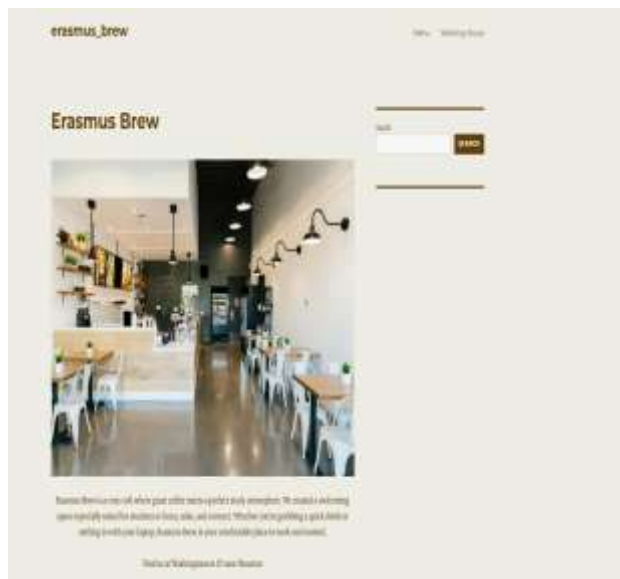
Week 6: AI-Assisted Brand Strategy & UI Redesign

Objective

To leverage generative AI tools to establish a cohesive brand identity, ideate UI layouts, and generate high-quality visual assets for a comprehensive website redesign.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **AI Prompt Engineering:** I engineered structured prompts to generate a comprehensive brand persona targeting both local and international university students. I specifically requested color palettes with HEX codes, Google Font pairings, and marketing pitches.
- **Design System Definition:** Based on the AI output, I defined a strict "Cozy, Modern, & Welcoming" aesthetic. I established a 3-color palette using Muted Rose (#DDA7A5), Rich Mocha Brown (#5C4A44), and Oat Milk Beige (#EFE8E1), and paired Montserrat and Open Sans fonts for high readability.
- **UI Layout Ideation:** I utilized AI to conceptualize a mobile-first homepage layout. The prompts ensured key conversion elements—such as a welcoming hero image, a quick Menu button, and student discounts—were prioritized in the architecture.
- **Visual Asset Generation:** I crafted detailed text-to-image prompts specifying lighting ("warm, inviting"), subjects ("diverse group of university students"), and camera parameters ("35mm lens") to generate high-quality, photorealistic hero images without requiring a professional photoshoot budget.
- **Design Iteration & Implementation:** I applied these newly established brand guidelines directly to the live WordPress site. The transition from the initial prototype to the finalized aesthetic is documented in the before-and-after UI captures.



Week 7: Lead Generation & Performance Optimization

Objective

To implement a strategic data capture mechanism for lead generation while simultaneously auditing and optimizing site performance to ensure a seamless user experience.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **Conversion Strategy & Value Exchange:** I designed a lead generation funnel utilizing a "Brew Crew Loyalty Voucher" and a "Student Guide to Prague Study Spots" as lead magnets. This creates a compelling value exchange for the target demographic of cost-conscious students.
- **Data Minimization & Segmentation:** I engineered a streamlined capture form prioritizing essential data: Name for personalization, Email for digital delivery, and a University dropdown (e.g., Charles, CTU, VSE) to facilitate future segmented marketing campaigns.
- **Privacy & Compliance:** I integrated a mandatory GDPR consent checkbox into the form architecture to ensure transparent and legal data collection practices.
- **Performance Auditing:** I conducted a site performance audit using Google Lighthouse, establishing a baseline Performance Score of 73. I identified high-resolution hero images as the primary bottleneck negatively impacting the Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) metric.
- **Asset Optimization:** I executed a media optimization strategy by converting heavy AI-generated image assets into the next-generation WebP format. This resulted in an approximate 70% reduction in file size, significantly improving load times without degrading the established brand aesthetic.

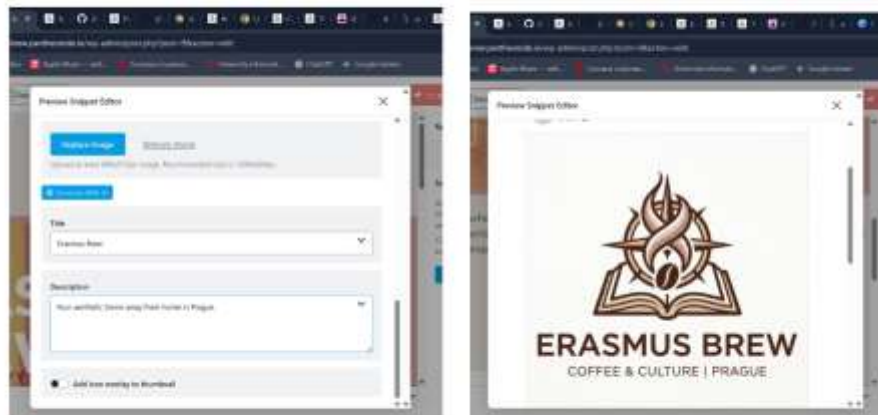
Week 8: Search Engine Optimization (SEO) & Social Open Graph Integration

Objective

To optimize the site's visibility on search engine results pages (SERPs) and ensure professional brand representation when shared across social media networks.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **Technical SEO Configuration:** I integrated the RankMath SEO plugin to establish a robust framework for on-page optimization. I generated an XML sitemap (sitemap_index.xml) to facilitate efficient crawling and indexing by search engine bots.
- **Metadata Optimization:** I crafted a concise, keyword-rich SEO title ("Erasmus Brew") and a compelling meta description ("Your aesthetic home away from home in Prague.") that adheres to character limits, ensuring optimal display on Google Search results.
- **Open Graph (Social Preview) Implementation:** To control how the website appears when shared on platforms like Facebook and WhatsApp, I configured Open Graph tags. I uploaded a custom high-resolution logo graphic to serve as the default social preview image, replacing the generic, unbranded default link appearance.
- **Social Link Integration:** I updated the site footer to include functional social media icons, bridging the gap between the website and external marketing channels.
- **Interactive Sharing Functionality:** I engineered a custom "Share this Menu" button utilizing the WhatsApp API. This feature allows users to easily distribute the cafe's digital menu directly to their personal networks via pre-populated messaging.



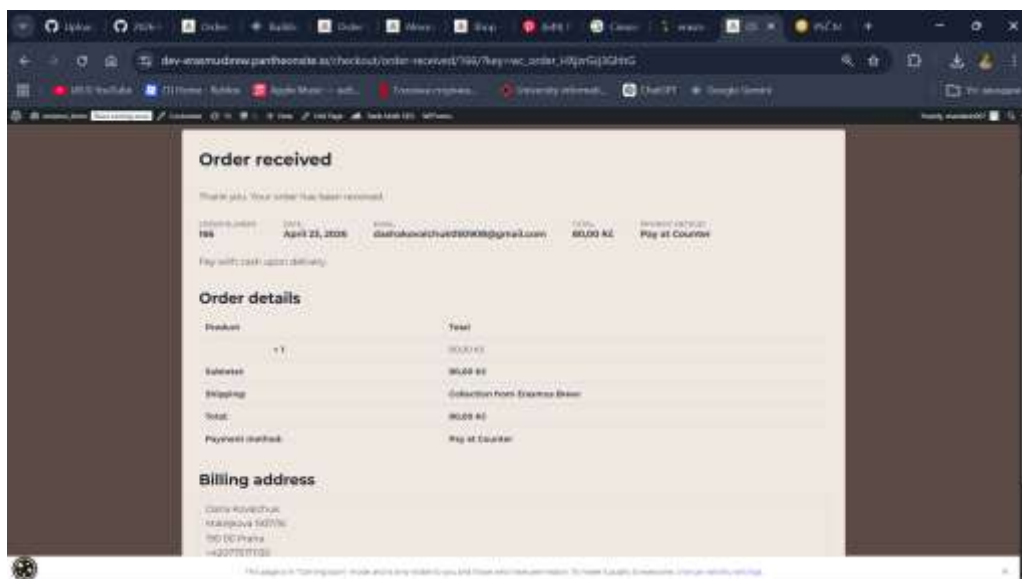
Week 9: E-Commerce Functionality & Checkout Optimization

Objective

To implement full e-commerce capabilities using WooCommerce, enabling online ordering, configuring product variations, and establishing automated inventory management.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **E-Commerce Checkout Configuration:** I successfully configured the WooCommerce checkout flow, specifically setting up a "Pay at Counter" offline payment gateway and a "Collection from Erasmus Brew" shipping method to support local cafe operations.
- **Variable Product Logic:** I engineered complex product types utilizing WooCommerce "Attributes" and "Variations." For example, I configured the Matcha Latte to allow customers to select their preferred milk type, offering Cow, Oat, and Soy options.
- **Automated Inventory Management:** I enabled the "Track stock quantity" feature to automate inventory control. By setting initial stock levels (e.g., starting an item at 8 units), the system automatically subtracts inventory upon order placement, dynamically updating the available stock shown to users.
- **User Experience (UX) Friction Testing:** I conducted a conversion funnel audit ("Friction Test") to evaluate the checkout efficiency. I verified that a user can successfully navigate from the homepage to a completed order confirmation in exactly 6 clicks, ensuring a highly optimized, low-friction purchasing experience.
- **Order Processing Verification:** I executed end-to-end test transactions to verify the system generates correct order numbers, calculates totals accurately in CZK, and correctly formats the billing and collection details.



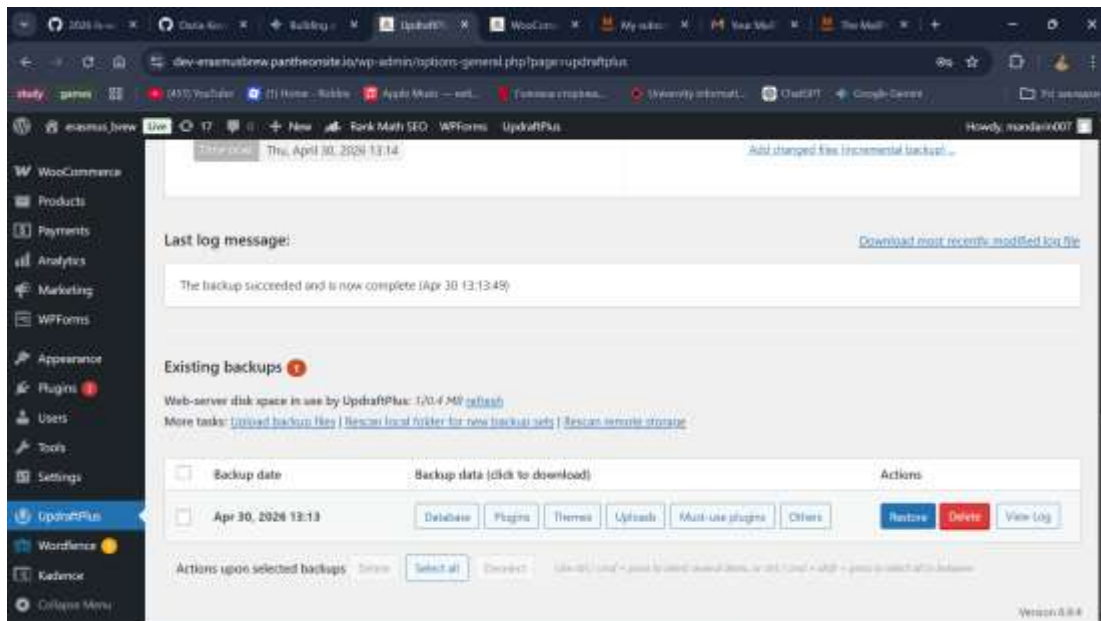
Week 10: CRM Automation, Audience Segmentation & Disaster Recovery

Objective

To implement automated customer relationship management (CRM) workflows, execute targeted marketing strategies, and ensure long-term business continuity through automated site backups.

Technical Achievements & Implementation

- **Promotional Strategy & Coupon Logic:** I engineered a strategic discount code (FRESHBREW67) designed to incentivize customer acquisition [cite: 27]. I implemented strict business logic parameters, offering a 15% discount contingent on a 100 CZK minimum spend to protect profit margins, while enforcing a 30-day expiration to create urgency [cite: 27, 28].
- **Email Marketing Automation:** I configured a triggered automated "Welcome" email sequence that dispatches exactly 1 minute after a user subscribes to the Brew Crew [cite: 28]. The email features an engaging subject line ("Welcome to the Brew Crew! (Here is your 15% off gift ☕)"), utilizes the established brand colors, and delivers the customized FLIGHTPLAN15 code to use on their first order [cite: 29, 30].
- **Audience Segmentation Strategy:** I implemented a data collection strategy within the lead capture form to gather zero-party data, specifically asking for the user's "Favorite Coffee" [cite: 31]. This allows for advanced list segmentation; for instance, targeting "Latte" drinkers with specific oat milk promotions without bothering the "Espresso" purists, significantly increasing email personalization and engagement [cite: 32, 33].
- **Site Reliability & Disaster Recovery:** To ensure business continuity and protect the 10 weeks of development infrastructure, I installed the UpdraftPlus plugin. I successfully executed a comprehensive, full-site backup (capturing the Database, Plugins, Themes, and Uploads), establishing a critical foundational disaster recovery protocol.



I really appreciated the structure of moving from raw HTML/CSS straight into a live WordPress sandbox. It made the jump to a real CMS make a lot of sense. For future classes, it might be cool to spend a little more time specifically on troubleshooting WooCommerce layouts (like dealing with the ragged grids). That was the trickiest part to figure out on my own, though finding the CSS fix was really rewarding!